07-19 第二篇

Learning to Say No

Many people find it difficult to refuse requests from others, even when saying yes leaves them stressed, exhausted, or unable to focus on what matters most to them. Learning to set boundaries by saying no is an important skill for both mental health and personal growth. [1] Understanding why we struggle to say no can help us become more confident in our choices. Often, we worry about disappointing others, being seen as unkind, or missing out on opportunities. These fears can lead us to agree to things we do not really want to do.

[2] Saying no does not mean you are selfish or rude—it means you are aware of your own limits and priorities. When you decline politely and clearly, you protect your time and energy for the things that truly matter to you. People who respect you will understand your boundaries. In fact, setting clear limits often leads to healthier and more honest relationships, because both sides know where they stand.

[3] There are practical ways to say no that feel comfortable and respectful. You can offer a brief explanation without over-apologizing, such as "I'm not able to take that on right now" or "That doesn't work for my schedule." You can also suggest an alternative or a different time if you are open to helping later. The key is to be direct and kind, without making excuses that invite further pressure.

[4] Practice makes it easier to say no when it matters. Start with smaller, low-stakes situations—declining an extra task, turning down an invitation you are not interested in—and gradually build your confidence. Over time, saying no will feel less uncomfortable and more like a normal part of protecting your wellbeing. Many people find that once they start setting boundaries, they feel less stressed and more in control of their lives.

[5] Learning to say no is a journey that takes time and patience, but the benefits are real. By honoring your own needs and limits, you create space for what truly matters—better health, stronger relationships, and the freedom to pursue your own goals. Saying no when appropriate is not a sign of weakness; it is a sign of self-respect and wisdom.

选项

A. Recognizing these reasons is the first step toward making healthier decisions. B. Setting boundaries is a sign of self-awareness and often improves your connections with others. C. Using simple, clear language can make refusal easier while still showing respect. D. Starting small and practicing regularly helps build the confidence to say no. E. In the end, saying no when you need to is a valuable skill that supports your wellbeing.

F. For example, some people say yes to every social invitation and end up feeling drained.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前提出学会说"不"的重要性，空后分析我们难以拒绝的常见原因（怕让人失望、被认为不友善等）。A 句 "Recognizing these reasons" 指代空后列举的原因，"first step toward making healthier decisions" 与前文 "understanding why" 形成自然衔接，承上启下。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：段落主题是说"不"不等于自私无礼，而是对自身限度和优先级的认知。空后提到礼貌拒绝能保护时间精力、获得尊重、促进更真诚的关系。B 句 "self-awareness" 与 "often improves your connections" 精准概括本段。
- **[3] C**：
  - **线索**：段落介绍具体、得体的拒绝方式。空后举例 "I'm not able to take that on right now" 等表达，强调直接且友善。C 句 "Using simple, clear language... while still showing respect" 准确对应本段内容。
- **[4] D**：
  - **线索**：段落讲通过练习逐步建立说"不"的信心。空后建议从小事、低风险情境开始练习。D 句 "Starting small and practicing regularly" 与后文描述完全吻合。
- **[5] E**：
  - **线索**：结尾段总结学会说"不"是长期过程，并强调其好处。E 句 "saying no when you need to is a valuable skill that supports your wellbeing" 与前文 "benefits"、"honoring your own needs" 自然呼应，作为总结句恰当。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example...**：虽涉及社交邀请和精力耗竭，但属于举例说明难以说"不"的后果，应嵌入第 1 段内部作支撑。作为独立选项，其层级为细节例证，与任何空位所需的段落概括句不符，易因主题相关而误选。